

6 Ways to Pay Less Money for a College Degree

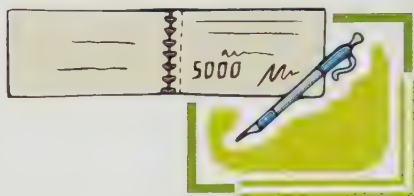
A four-year college degree can be one of the most expensive purchases in a person's lifetime. In fact, many hard-working professionals continue to pay for their college education long after graduation. Here are six ways you can expect to pay less money for a traditional four-year college degree.

1. Start early

Some colleges allow high school students to begin taking college courses while attending high school. Home-schooled students and those attending a participating high school can take up to 12 AP classes before graduation. By paying for and completing these classes early, it can help to offset costs later on.

2. Attend a community college

With costs sometimes as high as a third of their pricier private and state counterparts, community colleges are a great



buy. If getting a degree there doesn't interest you, consider their generous transfer programs. They allow a student to initially obtain a large number of credit hours at the cheaper college cost. You would still be considered a graduate of the state or private college.

3. Do it in three years

Several colleges offer summer class options to their students. By combining the summer semester with two 20-hour regular semesters, it is possible to graduate well ahead of schedule. Even with the summer semester costs, it is far cheaper than going the full four or five years.

4. Challenge the requirements

Many colleges allow students to "test out" of required classes. To do so, a student must prove that they already know the course material, and therefore, they do not need to take the class. Providing documented life experience or taking a competence exam will often be enough to skip a course entirely.